

Shells

Some marine animals use seashells as body armor. Hermit crabs can make new homes in the empty shells of sea snails. These crabs even carry the shells around the ocean floor with them!



Red hermit crab making a snail shell into a new home



Sea turtle swimming through a coral reef

Coral

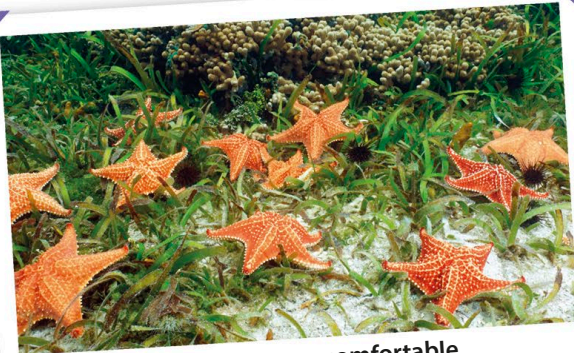
Colorful coral is an underwater playground for clown fish, seahorses, and sea turtles. Some sea snails attach coral to their shells for camouflage.

Rocky crevices

Hidden among shadowy rocks are crevices, or narrow cracks. Sea urchins, starfish, sea cucumbers, barnacles, spider crabs, and anemones use the darkness in these cracks to lie low and avoid predators.



Spiky sea urchins gather in groups next to the rocks.



Seagrasses are a comfortable habitat for starfish.

Seagrasses

These flowering plants provide hundreds of types of sea animals with a place to live. While starfish and sea urchins live among the long grasses, manatees and sea turtles eat these plants.